

thinking obviously does not have the Holy Spirit, and is therefore wide-open to satanic interference in his mind.¹

It will not do for someone to claim that he is only trying to be neutral; neither God nor Satan will allow neutrality. The Sovereign Creator, while He walked this earth as Jesus, was quite clear on the subject. “He who is not with me is against me, and he who does not gather with me scatters” (Matthew 12:30, Luke 11:23). Please note that this includes both what we believe and what we do: scattering is an activity. To work like an atheist is to be against Jesus. To practice atheistic textual criticism is to be against Jesus. Neutrality does not exist.

In 1881, when Westcott and Hort published their two-volume work, John William Burgon immediately began demonstrating that their theory and work was contrary to the empirical evidence. Burgon’s biographer wrote this: “Burgon was in this country [England] the leading religious teacher of his time”.² Burgon was a man of unquestioned scholarship; his biographer lists over fifty published works, on a considerable variety of subjects. His index of New Testament citations by early Christian leaders consists of sixteen thick manuscript volumes, to be found in the British Library; it contains 86,489 quotations.³ Burgon’s scholarship in this area of the total field has never been equaled. He may be the only person, living or dead, who personally collated each of the five great early uncials (known in his day)— $\aleph$, A, B, C, D—in their entirety (NT). He catalogued 374 Greek MSS; in those days there were not even microfilms, he had to go personally to wherever a MS was held.

Because of Burgon’s firsthand acquaintance with the empirical evidence, his refutation of Hort’s theory has never been answered, at least based on the evidence. He was either ignored, or misrepresented: ‘all he does is count MSS’, a perverse (and grotesque) falsehood; ‘he just doesn’t understand genealogy’, equally perverse and equally false.⁴ But the most

¹ I have written extensively on the subject of biblical spiritual warfare. Most of it may be found in my book, *Essays on Discipleship, Missions and Spiritual Warfare*, 2nd edition, 2017. It is also available from my website, www.prunch.org (or www.prunch.com.br). For starters, you should meditate on Ephesians 2:2, along with Luke 8:12 and 2 Corinthians 4:3-4.

² E.M. Goulburn, *Life of Dean Burgon* (London: John Murray, 1892, 2 vols.), I, vii.

³ Leo Vaganay, *An Introduction to the Textual Criticism of the New Testament*, trans. B.V. Miller (London: Sands and Co., Ltd., 1937), p. 48.

⁴ Most ‘scholars’ and professors are really ‘parrots’, just repeating what they were taught—they have never gone back to the source to see if it is true. How many Greek NT ‘scholars’ have collated even one Greek manuscript? (Did Hort collate any MSS?) They blindly accept what has been written on the subject, perhaps not realizing that most of